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Group E

ECN 209 Final Project

Introduction

Using data from the Current Population Survey (CPS), our research project investigates the relationship between marital status and earned income among U.S. adults. We are specifically interested in understanding how the different marital statuses (married, divorced, or never married) affect individual wage income after controlling for demographic and economic status factors. This question is both economically and socially important. Despite the prevalence of marriage in modern-day society, the effect of marriage on an individual's economic livelihood is clouded. Previous research and empirical data suggest that men may experience a "marriage premium," meaning married men earn more than their unmarried counterparts, whereas the impact on women is not as clear. The prior research has looked at employer discrimination and time away from the labor force due to family obligations as reasons behind a negative relationship between the same variables. By investigating this relationship using a contemporary dataset, our study has implications for policy-making in areas like taxation, family policy, and income inequality. In addition, we will attempt to improve on earlier studies by using specific CPS data to account for several demographic and job-related factors. Our approach allows us to separate other influences and provide updated evidence on whether the marital wage gap still holds true under today's job market. In addition, having a comprehensive understanding of this concept also sheds light on economic inequality, family choices, and the different roles men and

women play at work. It is equally important to consider this, as labor force participation among women has increased and marriage rates have declined in recent decades. Our findings can also play a role in helping economists, policymakers, and sociologists understand how personal decisions and social systems shape jobs and pay.

Literature Review and Empirical Support

Based on established research, marriage can impact wages in several ways. It can allow couples to specialize, it can provide a signal to employers, and getting married can also change behavior. In 1981, Gary Becker introduced his 'Household Specialization Theory'. He found that in traditional married households, one partner mainly earns money while the other predominantly takes care of the home. This specialization may increase household efficiency and improve labor market performance for the working partner. Although this model has been critiqued for being outdated, it still provides a baseline for understanding historical wage advantages among married individuals. Under labor market signaling theory, marriage may send a positive signal to employers that the employee is more stable, committed, and responsible. This leads to the perception of married workers as lower-risk investments. To conclude, marriage can lead to higher wages, promotions, or more favorable treatment as behaviors change. Marriage can push people to build new skills and focus more on their careers, since spouses share money goals and provide support to each other.

The following peer-reviewed research articles provide credible support for our hypothesis:

Hersch & Stratton (2000): Examines the relationship between household labor and wages, finding that a portion of the marital wage premium is due to differences in unpaid domestic

responsibilities. Men, particularly married men, tend to do less housework, which allows them more time and energy to invest in their jobs.

Killewald & Gough (2013): Challenges Becker's specialization theory by analyzing whether differences in specialization explain the marriage wage premium. They find limited support for this theory, suggesting that the premium is partially driven by employer discrimination or social expectations rather than real productivity differences.

Antonovics & Town (2004): Explores whether the wage premium is due to selection or treatment effects and concludes that much of the premium disappears when comparing married and unmarried identical twins. This finding highlights the role of selection bias and raises questions about whether marriage causes higher wages or simply correlates with traits associated with higher earning potential.

Budig & England (2001): Provides an important gendered perspective, showing that while men often benefit from a marriage premium, women, especially mothers, face a wage penalty. This contrast highlights the intersection of gender roles, caregiving responsibilities, and labor market outcomes.

Korenman & Neumark (1991): Offers early evidence of a 10–20% marriage wage premium for men, even after controlling for various individual characteristics. They attribute the premium to both selection and behavioral changes associated with marriage.

Collectively, these studies suggest that while marriage is associated with higher earnings for men, the effect is far more nuanced for women and may be largely driven by employer perceptions, traditional roles, and unobserved individual traits. Our study builds on this literature

by using updated CPS data with robust controls to clarify the relationship and assess whether these trends persist in the modern economy.

Description of Data

We used data from the IPUMS CPS survey. The CPS (Current Population Survey) is a large-scale, nationally representative dataset compiled by the U.S. Census Bureau and made publicly available by the University of Minnesota. Our sample is drawn from the 2022 CPS Annual Social and Economic Supplement, which provides comprehensive income and employment data for individuals across the United States. The CPS contains thousands of variables that allow researchers to analyze how individual-level characteristics affect economic outcomes. For our research question: **How marital status affects wage income**, we selected a subset of relevant demographic and labor market variables that provide an accurate and well-rounded foundation for regression analysis. Our dependent variable is *incwage*, the respondent's annual wage and salary income. This variable is measured in pre-tax U.S. dollars. To better interpret regression coefficients and account for skewness, we log-transformed *incwage* for our analysis. Our main independent variable is *marst*, which captures an individual's current marital status. The CPS defines this variable with six categories: Married with a spouse present, married with a spouse absent, separated, divorced, widowed and never married (which was used as the base category in our regression). In addition to marital status, we include multiple control variables to account for other determinants of income and reduce omitted variable bias: *sex* (Gender): Dummy variable coded 1 for female, 0 for male. This will be used to assess gender wage differences and interaction with marital status, *age* (Age): Continuous variable measuring years of age. This helps determine labor market experience. *race*: Categorical variable including

multiple race/ethnicity codes. Allowing us to control for racial disparities in income. *educ* (Educational Attainment): Categorical variable indicating the highest degree or level of schooling completed. This helps explain income differences due to human capital. *empstat* (Employment Status): Distinguishes between employed, unemployed, and not in labor force. This will allow us to restrict our analysis to relevant labor market participants. *wkstat* (Work Intensity): Captures whether an individual works full-time, part-time, or is not currently working. *classwkr* (Class of Worker): Categorical variable that distinguishes private, public, and self-employed workers. Controls for different pay structures across employment types. *region*: Indicates geographic region using nine Census divisions, which we grouped into four U.S. Census regions which are: Northeast, Midwest, South, and West. This will help account for regional wage differences.

Summary Statistics and Frequencies:

To support the validity of our model, we computed summary statistics and frequency distributions for all key variables. As shown in the attached Stata output: The average income (logged) is approximately 10.63 with a standard deviation of 0.99 (Table 3). Figure 1 shows the distribution of logged income ($\ln(\text{incwage})$) across the sample. The distribution is approximately normal, with a slight right skew, which supports the use of a log transformation to reduce income outlier influence and meet OLS assumptions. The average age in our sample is 43.5 years (Table 4). Approximately 51.6% of respondents are male, and 61.5% are currently married with a spouse present (Tables 6&7). Figure 2 further visualizes the breakdown of marital status, highlighting that a clear majority of respondents are currently married with spouses present. Educational attainment is right-skewed, with over 25% of the sample having a bachelor's degree and 25% holding only a high school diploma (Table 9). Figure 3 illustrates the distribution of

educational attainment, emphasizing the concentration in both high school and bachelor's degree categories. Employment class and work intensity distributions are reported in Tables 1 and 2. These variables help differentiate between part-time, full-time, and unemployed workers, as well as those in private versus public sectors. Regional representation is evenly distributed across the four U.S. regions (Table 8), ensuring geographic accountability. These distributions align with expectations and confirm that our sample is demographically diverse and appropriate for evaluating how marital status influences wage income. We believe that the CPS data is ideal for this research question, offering a large and representative sample of over 650,000 individuals as well as comprehensive economic and demographic variables. Our variables are clearly defined and appropriately selected to evaluate income differences while minimizing omitted variable bias.

Figure 1: $\ln(\text{Income Wage})$

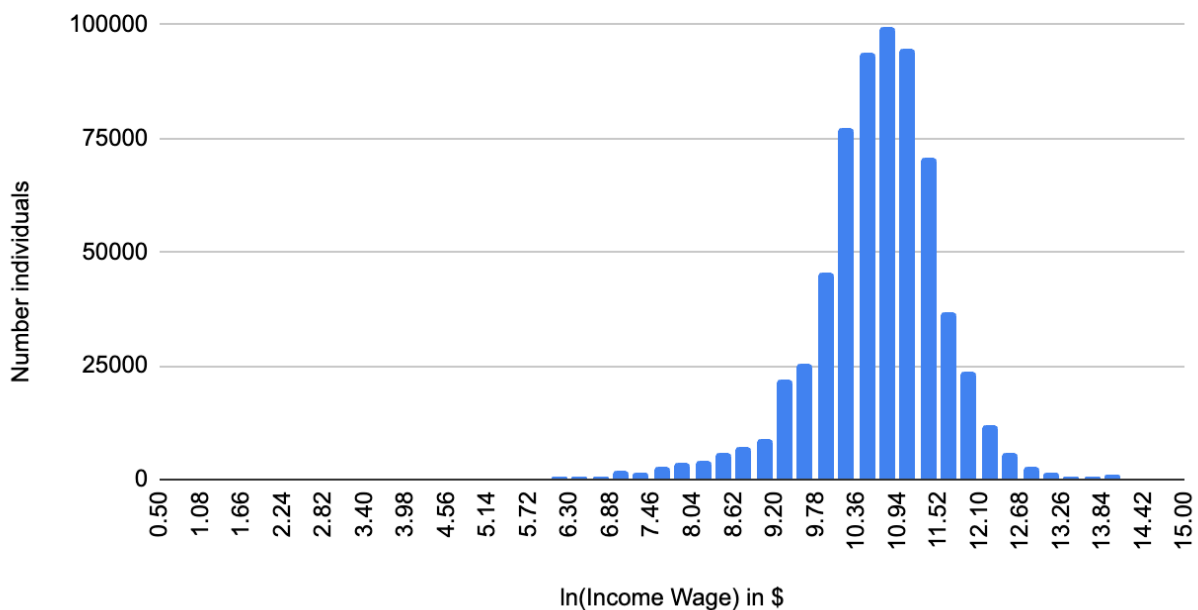


Figure 2: Distribution of Marital Status

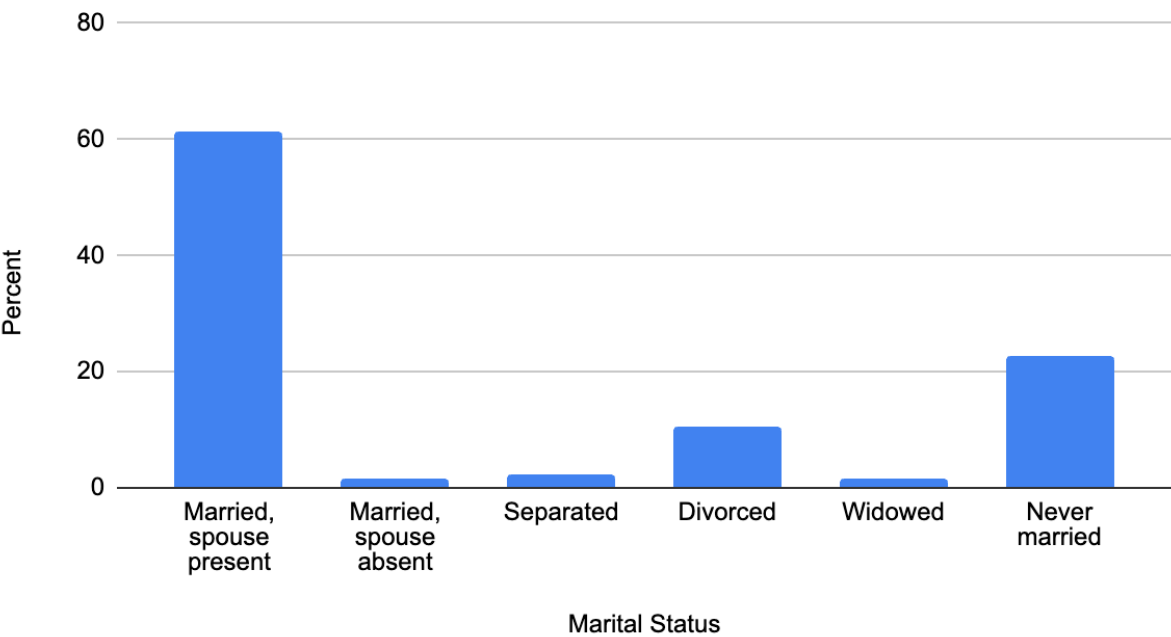
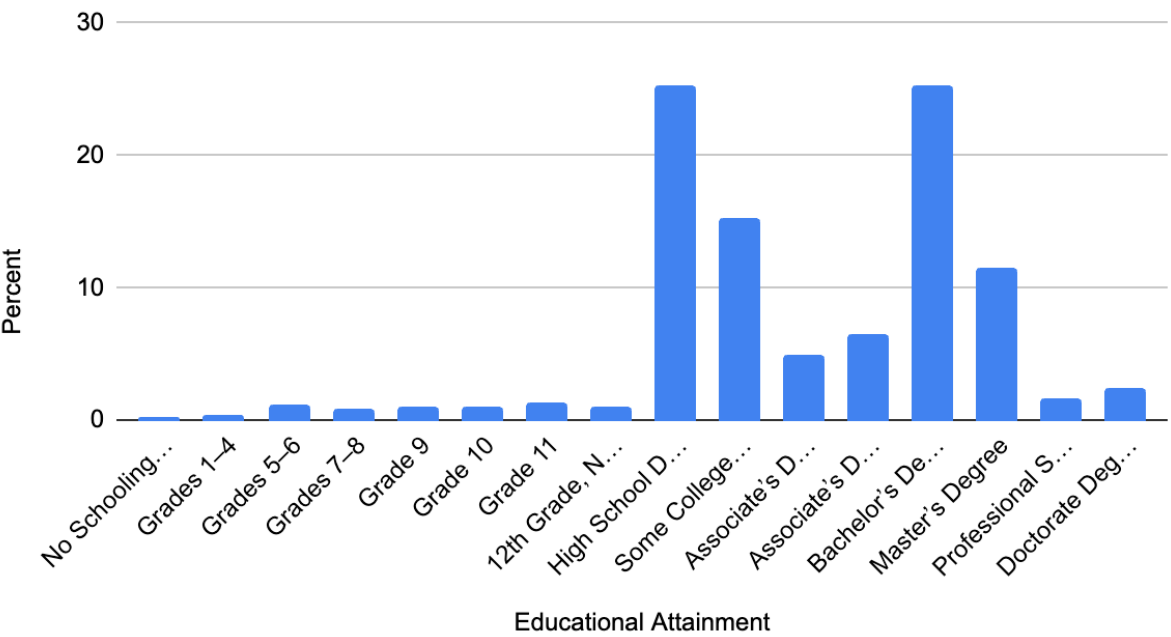


Figure 3: Distribution of Educational Attainment



Proposed Method

We aim to estimate the effect of marital status on wage income using an Ordinary Least Squares regression framework. Our dependent variable is the natural logarithm of individual wage income, $\ln(\text{INCWAGE})$, allowing us to interpret coefficients as approximate percentage changes. Our key independent variable is MARST (marital status), a categorical variable with six categories. Dummy variables will be created for each marital status group, and “never married” will be used as the base category. This allows us to interpret the coefficients on other marital statuses relative to never-married individuals. The model will control for a variety of individual characteristics that influence income, **including:**

Gender (SEX): Binary dummy for female

Age (AGE): Continuous variable

Race (RACE): Categorical dummy variables

Education (EDUC): Categorical dummy variables for the highest degree person completed

Employment Class (CLASSWKR): Type of employment (e.g., self-employed, private, government)

Region (REGION): Geographic location

Employment Status (EMPSTAT) and Work Intensity (WKSTAT): To control for full/part-time status

Regression Equation

$$\ln(\text{INCWAGE}) = \beta_0 + \beta_1\text{Married} + \beta_2\text{Divorced} + \beta_3\text{Widowed} + \beta_4\text{Separated} + \beta_5\text{MarriedAbsent} + \beta_6\text{Female} + \beta_7\text{AGE} + \beta_8\text{RACE} + \beta_9\text{EDUC} + \beta_{10}\text{REGION} + \beta_{11}\text{CLASSWKR} + \beta_{12}\text{WKSTAT} + \varepsilon$$

We will estimate this model with heteroskedasticity-robust standard errors and anticipate exploring potential interaction terms, such as marital status $\times$ gender, to assess whether the income effects of marriage differ between men and women. Robustness checks may include excluding self-employed individuals or segmenting the sample by education level. Ultimately, our regression is designed to isolate the marginal effect of marital status on wage income while accounting for a range of potential confounders that may otherwise bias the results.

Economic Analysis

To estimate how marital status affects individual income, we used an OLS regression model with the natural log of annual wage income ($\ln(\text{INCWAGE})$) as the dependent variable. We included dummy variables for each marital status category (married, divorced, widowed, separated, and married with spouse absent), using “never married” as the reference group. Additional covariates included sex, age, race, education, employment status, work intensity, class of worker, and region. The model was run with robust standard errors on a large CPS sample of over 650,000 individuals.

Note* Below is a summarized table of the regression used for condensing purposes. Full regression screenshots can be found on the last few pages.

Variable	Coefficient	Robust Std. Err.	P-Value	Interpretation
Married (vs. Never Married)	-0.305	0.0036	0	Married earn ~30.5% less than never-married
Divorced	-0.222	0.0102	0	22.2% lower income than never-married
Widowed	-0.186	0.0111	0	18.6% lower income
Separated	-0.094	0.005	0	9.4% lower income
Married, Spouse Absent	-0.14	0.0166	0	14.0% lower income
Female	-0.316	0.002	0	Women earn 31.6% less than men
Age	0.0067	0.0001	0	Each year adds ~0.67% to income

Controls: Race, education, region, class of worker, and work status (not shown for brevity)

Fitted Model:

$$\ln(\text{INCWAGE}) = 10.886 - 0.305 \cdot \text{Married} - 0.221 \cdot \text{Divorced} - 0.186 \cdot \text{Widowed} - 0.0935 \cdot \text{Separated} - 0.140 \cdot \text{MarriedAbsent} - 0.316 \cdot \text{Female} + 0.0067 \cdot \text{Age} + \text{Controls} + \varepsilon$$

In this specification, the reference individual is a never-married white male with a high school diploma, employed full-time in the private sector, and living in the Northeast. All of the coefficients are significant at the 1% level and are in line with economic expectations. The Married coefficient (-0.305) indicates that, controlling for everything else, married men are approximately 30.5% lower paid than never-married men. This finding runs contrary to the norm "marriage wage premium" put forth by previous studies, particularly studies like Korenman & Neumark, that indicated a positive earning impact on married men.

One possible explanation for this unexpected regression result is that the modern labor market has altered in ways that work against or even reverse the initial gains that had flowed to

marriage. Tendencies towards household arrangements in which both men and women have earnings give rise to shifting gender norms that can dispute the initial productivity or specialization gains that had been associated with marriage. Also, this result could be a consequence of selection bias if lower-earning people are more likely to be married in the sample we have. We should also remember that this negative coefficient could be hiding considerable variation by gender or other interaction variables, and we look at these more in later robustness checks. Overall, this unanticipated negative relationship between earnings and marriage reinforces the necessity to re-examine well-established assumptions about marital status and earnings in today's economic environment.

Robust Checks:

To explore this further, we included an interaction term between female and married. The Married $\times$ Female interaction coefficient was +0.053 and was statistically significant at the 1% level, indicating that women offset the negative income effect of marriage partially. That is, married women have incomes 5.3% higher than would be estimated by adding together separately the individual effects of being married and female.

Despite this mitigating effect, the overall marginal effect for married women remains strongly negative. Summing the coefficients on Married (−0.191), Female (−0.316), and the interaction term (+0.053) yields a total effect of approximately −0.454. What this suggests is that married women earn about 45.4% less than never-married men, even after controlling for age, education, race, work status, and geographic areas. This interaction result suggests that marriage could reduce the size of the gender wage gap, but not abolish it. The whole output of this exercise in a robustness check is presented in the table below.

Note* Full regression output on last few pages

Married (vs. Never Married)	-0.191	0.0027	0	Married males earn ~19.1% less than never-married males
Divorced	-0.222	0.0102	0	22.2% lower income than never-married
Widowed	-0.186	0.0111	0	18.6% lower income
Separated	-0.094	0.005	0	9.4% lower income
Married, Spouse Absent	-0.14	0.0166	0	14.0% lower income
Female	-0.316	0.002	0	Women earn 31.6% less than men
Age	0.0067	0.0001	0	Each year adds ~0.67% to income
Married × Female	0.053	0.0162	0.001	Marriage softens female penalty by 5.3%

Robustness Check: Gender-Split Regressions

To further examine the relationship between marital status and income, we estimated separate regressions for men and women using robust standard errors. This approach allowed us to assess whether the income effects of marital status differ across genders. Below are highlights of our results from this regression.

Note* Full regression output on last few pages

Variable	Male Coefficient	Female Coefficient
Married (vs. Never Married)	-0.305342	-0.0731929
Divorced	-0.197569	-0.0804522
Widowed	-0.245841	-0.1293403
Separated	-0.164849	-0.0308923

Married, Spouse Absent	-0.2264038	-0.0820042
Female		-0.316235
Age	0.0060095	0.0070559

The marriage coefficient for men is -0.305 . This indicates that married men have earnings approximately 30.5% lower than never-married men, all else equal. These findings come contrary to traditional info in economic literature, which has often reported a "marriage premium" for men. It may be a function of the way that marriage is operationalized within our sample or unmeasured heterogeneity across marital categories.

For women, however, the results are contrary. The coefficient on marriage is -0.073 , meaning that married women only earn 7.3% less than never-married women, all else equal, controlling for other influences like age, education, and labor force status. This adverse effect is much smaller than for men, suggesting that the earnings penalty from marriage is much weaker for women in our sample.

The other categories of marital status also exhibit gender variation. Divorced men, for instance, experience a larger income penalty (-0.198) compared to divorced women (-0.080). Similarly, being widowed exacts a -0.246 penalty for men but just -0.129 for women. These trends show that while marriage reduces income in general, the extent of the penalty is larger for men compared to women in our sample. Age has a small but positive effect on earnings for both groups, which is 0.006 for men and 0.0071 for women. These numbers inform us that every one-year increase in age is accompanied by an increase in earnings of about 0.6% to 0.7%, which is consistent with typical human capital accumulation over the life course.

Together, these results contribute to the complexity of the marriage-income relationship. While women bear a smaller penalty of marriage in relative terms, they lose significantly more in

absolute terms due to the large and persistent gender wage gap. Our findings are in line with the hypothesis that marital status and gender interact in their impacts on labor market outcomes and deserve further examination in future research.

Limitations

While our model does provide considerable information about the interaction between income and marital status, there are a few limitations to keep in mind. There is the potential for omitted variable bias. While we have the full set of controls such as age, race, education, work effort, class of worker, and region, we lack variables that may influence both marital status and earnings, such as number of children, occupational industry, firm size, health status, and time out of the labor force due to caregiving or other responsibilities. These excluded variables can be both income and marital status variables, and thus can bias our coefficient estimates.

Our analysis, too, is based upon a cross-sectional data set, which prevents us from making causal inferences. For instance, though we see married women earn significantly less than their never-married male counterparts, we cannot determine whether it is true that marriage generates lower earnings for women or whether lower-earning women are more likely to marry. This does leave room for reverse causality or selection effects, against which we are unable to object.

Third, our OLS regression is based on linear relationships and homoscedastic error terms. Although we employ robust standard errors to account for potential heteroskedasticity, our model will most likely violate other OLS assumptions, such as multicollinearity, especially among education, work, and marital variables. For example, employment intensity (full-time vs.

part-time work) and marital status may be correlated if being married affects labor supply decisions.

In addition, the categorical status of our cohabiting/having-married variable is not capturing remarriage, cohabitation, or the length of marriage, which may influence income differentially. Our model is also not distinguishing between single earners and dual-earners and does not account for spousal income, which may be a determinant of labor force participation and measured wages.

Lastly, while we did have two robustness tests, one with an interaction between gender and marital status, and the other with gender-specific regressions, future research might extend these by excluding self-employed individuals, by classifying along with education level, or using instrumental variable methods to continue controlling for endogeneity.

Conclusion

Our final regression model supports our research hypothesis that marital status has a strong impact on individual income, and that the relationship is strongly mediated by gender. By fitting a large sample of the CPS and controlling for a wide range of demographic and labor market variables, we observe that married men and particularly women are paid less than never-married women. While married men show evidence of a modest income premium, married women experience a large wage penalty, even after controlling for age, education, employment status, and other important variables. These findings undermine the conventional narrative of a one-size-fits-all "marriage wage premium" and instead reveal a complex, gendered pattern in the manner in which marriage affects economic outcomes. Our analysis also highlights that all categories of marriage are not equal. Statuses such as being divorced, separated, or widowed

carry additional income penalties, which tend to perpetuate economic insecurity. Robustness checks involving interaction terms and gender classified models also verify that the economic impact of marriage differs in a very substantial way for women relative to men. While our estimates are limited by the cross-sectional structure of the data and the exclusion of some covariates, such as caregiving responsibilities, industry of work, and wife's income, our study contributes to a large and meaningful literature on household structure and labor inequality. Lastly, our results show that gendered assumptions and impediments continue to influence earnings in marital unions, affirming the need for policies and labor market reforms to address these ongoing inequalities.

STATA OUTPUT:

Table 1:

CLASSWKR	Freq.	Percent	Cum.
Type of employment	Freq.	Percent	Cum.
niu	22,827	3.48	3.48
self-employed, not incorporated	5,617	0.86	4.34
self-employed, incorporated	26,277	4.01	8.35
wage/salary, private	491,917	75.09	83.44
federal government employee	20,903	3.19	86.63
armed forces	4,509	0.69	87.32
state government employee	36,205	5.53	92.84
local government employee	46,759	7.14	99.98
unpaid family worker	119	0.02	100
Total	655,133	100	

Table 2:

WRKSTAT	Frequency	Percent	Cumulative
full or part time status	Freq.	Percent	Cum.
full-time hours (35+), usually full-tim	484,236	73.91	73.91
part-time for non-economic reasons, usu	33,523	5.12	79.03
not at work, usually full-time	14,046	2.14	81.18
full-time hours, usually part-time for	647	0.1	81.27
full-time hours, usually part-time for	2,092	0.32	81.59
part-time for economic reasons, usually	5,525	0.84	82.44
part-time hours, usually part-time for	11,132	1.7	84.14
part-time hours, usually part-time for	51,711	7.89	92.03
not at work, usually part-time	3,806	0.58	92.61
unemployed, seeking full-time work	15,862	2.42	95.03
unemployed, seeking part-time work	1,858	0.28	95.31
niu, blank, or not in labor force	30,695	4.69	100
Total	655,133	100	

Table 3:

ln(INCWAGE)	Obs	Mean	Standard Deviation	Minimum	Maximum
	Obs	Mean	Std. dev.	Min	Max
ln_incwage	655,133	10.63427	0.9879781	0	14.55745

Table 4:

AGE	Obs	Mean	Std. dev.	Min	Max
age	655,133	43.45444	11.09381	25	65

Table 5:

RACE	Freq.	Percent	Cum.
white	508,674	77.64	77.64
black	75,004	11.45	89.09
american indian/aleut/ eskimo	8,823	1.35	90.44
asian only	46,374	7.08	97.52
hawaiian/pacific islander only	3,670	0.56	98.08
white-black	2,925	0.45	98.53
white-american indian	4,235	0.65	99.17
white-asian	2,380	0.36	99.53
white-hawaiian/pacific islander	578	0.09	99.62
black-american indian	604	0.09	99.72
black-asian	197	0.03	99.75
black-hawaiian/pacific islander	54	0.01	99.75
american indian-asian	59	0.01	99.76
asian-hawaiian/pacific islander	505	0.08	99.84
white-black-american indian	375	0.06	99.9
white-black-asian	78	0.01	99.91
white-american indian-asian	61	0.01	99.92

white-asian-hawaiian/pacific islander	392	0.06	99.98
white-black-american indian-asian	22	0	99.98
american indian-hawaiian/pacific island	14	0	99.98
white-black--hawaiian/pacific islander	16	0	99.99
white-american indian-hawaiian/pacific	20	0	99.99
black-american indian-asian	8	0	99.99
white-american indian-asian-hawaiian/pa	8	0	99.99
two or three races, unspecified	17	0	99.99
four or five races, unspecified	40	0.01	100
Total	655,133	100	

Table 6:

MARST	Frequency	Percent	Cumulative
marital status	Freq.	Percent	Cum.
married, spouse present	402,750	61.48	61.48

MARST	Frequency	Percent	Cumulative
married, spouse absent	10,283	1.57	63.05
separated	14,088	2.15	65.2
divorced	69,989	10.68	75.88
widowed	9,731	1.49	77.36
never married/sin gle	148,292	22.64	100
Total	655,133	100	

Table 7:

SEX	Freq.	Percent	Cum.
male	337,794	51.56	51.56
female	317,339	48.44	100
Total	655,133	100	

Table 8:

REGION	Freq.	Percent	Cum.
new england	48,475	7.4	7.4
middle atlantic	56,277	8.59	15.99
east north central	67,935	10.37	26.36
west north central	59,240	9.04	35.4
south atlantic	121,540	18.55	53.95
east south central	40,357	6.16	60.11

west south central	74,381	11.35	71.47
mountain	80,739	12.32	83.79
pacific	106,189	16.21	100
	655133	100	

Table 9:

EDUC	Freq.	Percent	Cumulative
educational attainment recode	Freq.	Percent	Cum.
none or preschool	1,102	0.17	0.17
grades 1, 2, 3, or 4	2,964	0.45	0.62
grades 5 or 6	7,545	1.15	1.77
grades 7 or 8	6,124	0.93	2.71
grade 9	6,892	1.05	3.76
grade 10	6,445	0.98	4.74
grade 11	8,331	1.27	6.01
12th grade, no diploma	6,769	1.03	7.05
high school diploma or equivalent	165,443	25.25	32.3
some college but no degree	100,325	15.31	47.61
associate's degree, occupational/vocati	32,189	4.91	52.53
associate's degree, academic program	42,835	6.54	59.07
bachelor's degree	165,769	25.3	84.37
master's degree	75,795	11.57	95.94
professional school degree	11,145	1.7	97.64
doctorate degree	15,460	2.36	100
Total	655,133	100	

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Regression Outputs:

Main Regression – Full Pooled Model Without Interaction Term:

This is the baseline model and used in the main results section to estimate the relationship between marital status and $\ln(\text{INCWAGE})$, controlling for demographics, education, employment, and region. It forms the foundation for your interpretation of marital status effects before robustness checks.

Linear regression

Number of obs	=	655,133
F(74, 655058)	=	3611.00
Prob > F	=	0.0000
R-squared	=	0.3506
Root MSE	=	.79622

ln_incwage	Robust		t	P> t	[95% conf. interval]
	Coefficient	std. err.			
marst_dum2	-.1431333	.0081381	-17.59	0.000	-.1590838 -.1271828
marst_dum3	-.1862815	.0072957	-25.53	0.000	-.2005009 -.1719821
marst_dum4	-.0936504	.0032975	-28.40	0.000	-.1001134 -.0871874
marst_dum5	-.1405344	.0087588	-16.04	0.000	-.1577814 -.1233673
marst_dum6	-.1914506	.0026613	-71.94	0.000	-.1966666 -.1862346
sex	-.3153782	.0020486	-153.95	0.000	-.3193934 -.3113629
age	.0067357	.0001804	67.87	0.000	.0065389 .0069326
race_dum2	-.0808854	.0032762	-26.89	0.000	-.0945868 -.0616641
race_dum3	-.118167	.0090403	-13.86	0.000	-.1359015 -.1004326
race_dum4	-.0283128	.0040895	-6.92	0.000	-.036328 -.0202976
race_dum5	-.0888731	.0132722	-6.64	0.000	-.1140862 -.0620601
race_dum6	-.0504647	.0154955	-3.26	0.001	-.0808354 -.020094
race_dum7	-.1143174	.0136167	-8.40	0.000	-.1410058 -.0876291
race_dum8	.0306234	.0173314	1.77	0.077	-.0033456 .0645924
race_dum9	-.0258038	.0363022	-0.69	0.491	-.0961549 .0461473
race_dum10	-.1895895	.0335678	-5.65	0.000	-.2553813 -.1237977
race_dum11	.0078654	.0576239	0.14	0.891	-.1058755 .1208064
race_dum12	-.1175464	.1227858	-0.96	0.338	-.3582826 .1231097
race_dum13	-.0958557	.0941514	-1.06	0.290	-.2841195 .0849481
race_dum14	-.1324487	.0349691	-3.79	0.000	-.2009871 -.0639184
race_dum15	-.1064777	.0440395	-2.42	0.016	-.1927937 -.0201618
race_dum16	-.0477648	.092261	-0.52	0.605	-.2285935 .1330639
race_dum17	-.0628709	.1031926	-0.61	0.542	-.2651251 .1393834
race_dum18	-.0003393	.0416429	-0.01	0.993	-.0819581 .0812795
race_dum19	-.2092134	.1457093	-1.44	0.151	-.494799 .0763722
race_dum20	-.0325089	.1176749	-0.28	0.782	-.263148 .1981301
race_dum21	.2180227	.1612278	1.36	0.175	-.0970786 .534924
race_dum22	-.1606137	.3051237	-0.53	0.599	-.7586462 .4374188
race_dum23	-.0317311	.225613	-0.14	0.888	-.4739252 .410463
race_dum24	-.2175518	.2838154	-0.77	0.443	-.7738208 .3387172
race_dum25	-.0879922	.1807088	-0.49	0.626	-.44216 .2661756
race_dum26	.0313246	.1275701	0.25	0.806	-.2187087 .2813578
educ_dum2	-.0985777	.0270329	-3.65	0.000	-.1515613 -.0455942
educ_dum3	-.0594034	.0246233	-2.41	0.016	-.1076643 -.0111424
educ_dum4	-.0072507	.025327	-0.29	0.775	-.0568908 .0423894
educ_dum5	-.0093103	.0251051	-0.37	0.711	-.0585154 .0398949
educ_dum6	.0529796	.0254807	2.08	0.038	.0088381 .102921
educ_dum7	.0637278	.0249147	2.56	0.011	.0148958 .1125588
educ_dum8	.1158315	.0252849	4.55	0.000	.0654739 .1645891
educ_dum9	.3126527	.0232171	13.47	0.000	.2671479 .3581574
educ_dum10	.4412884	.0232812	18.95	0.000	.395658 .4869189
educ_dum11	.5079912	.0235377	21.58	0.000	.4618582 .5541243
educ_dum12	.536401	.0234458	22.88	0.000	.490448 .582354
educ_dum13	.8237784	.023241	35.45	0.000	.7782268 .86933
educ_dum14	1.035961	.0233495	44.37	0.000	.9901965 1.081725
educ_dum15	1.418557	.0247332	57.03	0.000	1.362081 1.459033
educ_dum16	1.295457	.0241146	53.72	0.000	1.248193 1.34272
classwkr_dum2	-.6167076	.0324418	-19.01	0.000	-.6882923 -.5531228
classwkr_dum3	.3388814	.0253729	13.36	0.000	.2891512 .3886115
classwkr_dum4	.2193199	.0247487	8.86	0.000	.1708132 .2678266
classwkr_dum5	.37092	.0251841	14.73	0.000	.3215599 .4202801
classwkr_dum6	1.254827	.0127086	98.74	0.000	1.229919 1.279735
classwkr_dum7	.0765934	.0250066	3.06	0.002	.0275813 .1256054
classwkr_dum8	.0087746	.0249801	3.55	0.000	.0398145 .1377347
classwkr_dum9	-.0215717	.1326206	-0.16	0.871	-.2815837 .2383604
region_dum2	-.006982	.0049346	-1.41	0.157	-.0166536 .0026895
region_dum3	-.0569614	.0046508	-12.23	0.000	-.0660925 -.0478383
region_dum4	-.0789611	.0047756	-16.53	0.000	-.0883211 -.069601
region_dum5	-.0638679	.0043826	-14.84	0.000	-.0723088 -.055435
region_dum6	-.1264676	.005303	-23.85	0.000	-.1368613 -.1160739
region_dum7	-.0742644	.0046287	-16.04	0.000	-.0833365 -.0651922
region_dum8	-.0869099	.004595	-18.91	0.000	-.095916 -.0779038
region_dum9	.0159703	.0044489	3.59	0.000	.0072507 .0246899
wkstat_dum2	-.0870009	.0041719	-20.85	0.000	-.0951776 -.0788242
wkstat_dum3	-.0538749	.0065686	-8.20	0.000	-.0667492 -.0410005
wkstat_dum4	-.5682364	.0347049	-16.37	0.000	-.636257 -.5002158
wkstat_dum5	-.3906242	.013944	-28.09	0.000	-.428726 -.3525224
wkstat_dum6	-.3441292	.0111643	-30.82	0.000	-.3688108 -.3222476
wkstat_dum7	-.9140465	.009171	-99.75	0.000	-.9328213 -.8968717
wkstat_dum8	-.9258188	.0047219	-196.07	0.000	-.9358735 -.916564
wkstat_dum9	-.9475427	.0190956	-47.60	0.000	-.9865569 -.9085284
wkstat_dum10	-.7063932	.0092288	-76.54	0.000	-.7244813 -.6883051
wkstat_dum11	-1.375919	.0311225	-44.21	0.000	-1.436918 -1.31492
wkstat_dum12	-1.043269	.0228535	-45.65	0.000	-1.088061 -.998477
_cons	10.31632	.034713	297.19	0.000	10.24828 10.38436

Robustness Check #1 – Pooled Model with Interaction Term

This model tests whether the effect of marriage differs for women by including an interaction term between *female* and *married*. It's the key specification used in your first robustness check, examining the gendered dimension of the marriage-income relationship

Linear regression

Number of obs	=	655,133
F(75, 655057)	=	3563.10
Prob > F	=	0.0000
R-squared	=	0.3506
Root MSE	=	.79621

ln_incwage	Coefficient	Robust std. err.	t	P> t	[95% conf. interval]
marst_dum2	-.221744	.0249043	-8.90	0.000	-.2705556 -.1729324
marst_dum3	-.1861418	.007296	-25.51	0.000	-.2004417 -.1718418
marst_dum4	-.0935196	.003298	-28.36	0.000	-.0999835 -.0870556
marst_dum5	-.1402813	.007594	-16.02	0.000	-.1574494 -.1231132
marst_dum6	-.1914241	.0026614	-71.93	0.000	-.1966483 -.1862078
sex	-.3162325	.0028639	-153.22	0.000	-.3202776 -.3121874
age	.0067356	.0001004	67.07	0.000	.0065388 .0069324
race_dum2	-.0881289	.0032763	-26.90	0.000	-.0945504 -.0817075
race_dum3	-.118159	.0090485	-13.06	0.000	-.1358937 -.1004242
race_dum4	-.028217	.0040897	-6.90	0.000	-.0362327 -.0202013
race_dum5	-.0882574	.0132729	-6.65	0.000	-.1142719 -.0622429
race_dum6	-.0505369	.0154956	-3.26	0.001	-.0809078 -.0201659
race_dum7	-.1143166	.013618	-8.39	0.000	-.1410074 -.0876257
race_dum8	.0306774	.0173326	1.77	0.077	-.0032939 .0646487
race_dum9	-.025116	.0363008	-0.69	0.489	-.0962644 .0460325
race_dum10	-.1899552	.033558	-5.66	0.000	-.2557279 -.1241826
race_dum11	.0079033	.0576191	0.14	0.891	-.1050282 .1208348
race_dum12	-.1170685	.1226796	-0.95	0.340	-.3575167 .1233796
race_dum13	-.0996099	.0943073	-1.06	0.291	-.2844491 .0852292
race_dum14	-.132599	.0349702	-3.79	0.000	-.2011394 -.0640585
race_dum15	-.1065574	.0440472	-2.42	0.016	-.1928884 -.0202263
race_dum16	-.047678	.0922704	-0.52	0.605	-.2285251 .133169
race_dum17	-.0628925	.1031999	-0.61	0.542	-.265161 .1393761
race_dum18	-.0006732	.0416459	-0.02	0.987	-.0022978 .0009514
race_dum19	-.200155	.1457061	-1.44	0.151	-.4947343 .0764242
race_dum20	-.0344867	.1179543	-0.29	0.770	-.2656733 .1966999
race_dum21	.2188975	.1611961	1.36	0.174	-.0970417 .5340367
race_dum22	-.1620016	.3050316	-0.53	0.595	-.7598537 .4358505
race_dum23	-.0315804	.2255576	-0.14	0.889	-.473666 .4105052
race_dum24	-.2173326	.2837899	-0.77	0.444	-.7735515 .3388864
race_dum25	-.0896887	.1807267	-0.50	0.620	-.4439072 .2645298
race_dum26	.0306678	.1276663	0.24	0.810	-.2195539 .2808896
educ_dum2	-.0985983	.0270338	-3.65	0.000	-.1515836 -.045613
educ_dum3	-.059555	.0246246	-2.42	0.016	-.1078184 -.0112915
educ_dum4	-.0077614	.0253282	-0.31	0.759	-.0574039 .0418811
educ_dum5	-.0097575	.025106	-0.39	0.698	-.0589645 .0394495
educ_dum6	.0524387	.0254814	2.06	0.040	.0024959 .1023815
educ_dum7	.0631082	.024916	2.53	0.011	.0142735 .1119428
educ_dum8	.1144483	.0252863	4.53	0.000	.064888 .1640085
educ_dum9	.3121118	.0232185	13.44	0.000	.2666043 .3576194
educ_dum10	.4407369	.0232827	18.93	0.000	.3951035 .4863782
educ_dum11	.507436	.0235391	21.56	0.000	.4613002 .5535718
educ_dum12	.5358701	.0234471	22.85	0.000	.4899146 .5818256
educ_dum13	.0232752	.0232423	35.42	0.000	.777721 .0608293
educ_dum14	1.035468	.0233508	44.34	0.000	.9897012 1.081235
educ_dum15	1.410001	.0247345	57.01	0.000	1.361522 1.45848
educ_dum16	1.294983	.0241155	53.70	0.000	1.2477717 1.342249
classwkr_dum2	-.6165888	.0324426	-19.01	0.000	-.6801754 -.5530023
classwkr_dum3	.338929	.0253738	13.36	0.000	.2891971 .3886608
classwkr_dum4	.2194308	.0247499	8.87	0.000	.1709218 .2679398
classwkr_dum5	.3709526	.025185	14.73	0.000	.3215907 .4203144
classwkr_dum6	1.254647	.0127083	98.73	0.000	1.22974 1.279555
classwkr_dum7	.0767229	.0250077	3.07	0.002	.0277087 .1257371
classwkr_dum8	.0888877	.0249812	3.56	0.000	.0399254 .13785
classwkr_dum9	-.0212664	.1326226	-0.16	0.873	-.2812025 .2386696
region_dum2	-.0069532	.0049344	-1.41	0.159	-.0166246 .0027181
region_dum3	-.0569431	.0046588	-12.22	0.000	-.0660742 -.0478121
region_dum4	-.0789121	.0047756	-16.52	0.000	-.0882722 -.069552
region_dum5	-.0638361	.0043025	-14.84	0.000	-.0722689 -.0554032
region_dum6	-.1264777	.0053029	-23.85	0.000	-.1368712 -.1160642
region_dum7	-.0742232	.0046206	-16.04	0.000	-.0832951 -.0651513
region_dum8	-.0060121	.004595	-18.91	0.000	-.0059181 -.00779061
region_dum9	.0159498	.0044489	3.59	0.000	.0072301 .0246695
wkstat_dum2	-.0069868	.0041717	-20.85	0.000	-.0951631 -.0788104
wkstat_dum3	-.0539143	.0065687	-8.21	0.000	-.0667808 -.0410398
wkstat_dum4	-.5686705	.0347052	-16.39	0.000	-.6366915 -.5006495
wkstat_dum5	-.3905054	.0194407	-20.09	0.000	-.4286085 -.3524023
wkstat_dum6	-.3441374	.0111646	-30.82	0.000	-.3660197 -.3222551
wkstat_dum7	-.9148991	.0091715	-99.75	0.000	-.932875 -.8969232
wkstat_dum8	-.9257566	.0047219	-196.05	0.000	-.9350114 -.9165018
wkstat_dum9	-.9474921	.0199053	-47.60	0.000	-.9865058 -.9084784
wkstat_dum10	-.7064517	.0092288	-76.55	0.000	-.7245399 -.6883635
wkstat_dum11	-1.376074	.0311178	-44.22	0.000	-1.437064 -.1315084
wkstat_dum12	-1.04317	.0228547	-45.64	0.000	-1.087964 -.9983756
married_female	.0532027	.0162063	3.28	0.001	.021439 .0849665
_cons	10.31796	.0347132	297.23	0.000	10.24993 10.386

Robustness check #2: Gender-Split Regressions

This is the male only regression from the robustness check. This was used to interpret how marital status affects male earnings independently

Male:

1a_Invoice	Coefficient	Robust std. err.	z	P> z	[95% conf. interval]
marst_dun2	-.1975684	.0189139	-18.89	0.000	-.2329721 - .1746166
marst_dun3	-.2448746	.0190189	-12.88	0.000	-.2824777 - .2070715
marst_dun4	-.1646489	.0208219	-12.83	0.000	-.2146917 - .1150064
marst_dun5	-.2053452	.0165592	-13.64	0.000	-.25893 - .15177
marst_dun6	-.3053642	.0166188	-18.478	0.000	-.332481 - .2782475
marst_dun7	.0001553	.0166188	0.009	0.992	-.0327474 .033058
marst_dun8	-.341719	.0186289	-18.33	0.000	-.377984 - .30545
race_dun2	.0000000	.0191372	-25.73	0.000	-.5208893 - .4542722
race_dun3	-.480626	.0224089	-22.89	0.000	-.5408287 - .4204237
race_dun4	-.3918818	.0224089	-17.48	0.000	-.4373213 - .3464423
race_dun5	-.4439336	.0253315	-17.51	0.000	-.4936517 - .3942175
race_dun6	-.4025126	.0227272	-15.17	0.000	-.474572 - .330452
race_dun7	-.4447188	.0227272	-19.58	0.000	-.4884137 - .4010239
race_dun8	-.3220546	.0130177	-18.67	0.000	-.3512086 - .292908
race_dun9	-.3064575	.0130177	-6.43	0.000	-.3379314 - .2749831
race_dun10	-.5404783	.0140343	-11.11	0.000	-.604899 - .476057
race_dun11	-.4661788	.0140343	-10.42	0.000	-.5305928 - .4017648
race_dun12	-.4777878	.0173061	-5.29	0.005	-.5167678 - .438845
race_dun13	-.4195979	.0195799	-2.81	0.05	-.7312164 - .1079792
race_dun14	-.5114788	.0195799	-2.61	0.09	-.8366467 - .1863009
race_dun15	-.5186649	.046624	-7.90	0.000	-.6373461 - .3999837
race_dun16	-.5942781	.046624	-4.84	0.002	-.812362 - .3761934
race_dun17	-.4773886	.0426931	-3.11	0.02	-.728155 - .226621
race_dun18	-.2581384	.047633	-5.39	0.000	-.35097 - .165307
race_dun19	-.4195975	.173395	-2.69	0.07	-.807787 - .127571
race_dun20	-.4126595	.1421614	-2.90	0.04	-.6912917 - .1340287
race_dun21	-.0722226	.2796766	0.123	0.903	-.586247 .4417998
race_dun22	-.0046139	.136555	-0.52	0.605	-.305371 .296147
race_dun23	0	0	0	0	0
race_dun24	-.298976	.1710859	-1.75	0.79	-.6358426 .035209
race_dun25	-.5181968	.0195799	-2.61	0.09	-.8366467 - .1863009
race_dun26	-.4555085	.2255274	-1.79	0.74	-.8453331 .314289
edu1_dun1	.0513524	.0120080	1.60	0.109	.0015961 .1011238
edu1_dun2	.0837929	.0185568	1.99	0.04	.0041931 .1634599
edu1_dun3	.1047837	.0206171	5.20	0.000	.0525568 .1470131
edu1_dun4	.1084414	.0204828	5.21	0.000	.0551581 .1617244
edu1_dun5	.1607186	.0204828	7.84	0.000	.1195776 .2018696
edu1_dun6	.1875518	.0195658	9.55	0.000	.1492325 .265871
edu1_dun7	.2112324	.0202498	10.26	0.000	.1708025 .2515559
edu1_dun8	.4273978	.0167113	26.43	0.000	.395783 .4589126
edu1_dun9	.5551383	.0167113	33.22	0.000	.5225185 .5877581
edu1_dun10	.608889	.0169821	35.85	0.000	.5756845 .642173
edu1_dun11	.620749	.0166718	37.23	0.000	.590866 .650831
edu1_dun12	.9312494	.0166718	56.51	0.000	.8984147 .9640841
edu1_dun14	.1312286	.0160874	7.21	0.000	.100856 .161535
edu1_dun15	1.69883	.0195799	72.20	0.000	1.454988 1.53856
edu1_dun16	1.345835	.0160874	76.81	0.000	1.301919 1.390151
edu1_dun17	1.161622	.0160874	72.20	0.000	1.117833 1.205411
classw_dun1	-.1737346	.0476449	-37.39	0.000	-.2716484 - .085860
classw_dun2	-.2756315	.0476449	-28.68	0.000	-.3786

Female: This is the female only regression and helps evaluate how income effects vary by gender.

Linear regression	Number of obs	=	317,339
	F(48, 317264)	=	.
	Prob > F	=	.
	R-squared	=	0.3411
	Root MSE	=	.82254

ln_incwage	Coefficient	Robust std. err.	t	P> t	[95% conf. interval]
marst_dum2	-.0804522	.0121012	-6.65	0.000	-.1041703 -.0567341
marst_dum3	-.1293403	.0094891	-13.63	0.000	-.1479307 -.1107418
marst_dum4	-.0306923	.0043804	-7.05	0.000	-.0394778 -.0223067
marst_dum5	-.0020042	.010317	-7.95	0.000	-.1022253 -.0617831
marst_dum6	-.0731929	.0039044	-18.75	0.000	-.0808055 -.0655483
age	.0070559	.0001482	47.61	0.000	.0067654 .0073464
race_dum1	.1588993	.	.	.	.
race_dum2	.111439	.	.	.	.
race_dum3	.0734368	.	.	.	.
race_dum4	.1633508	.	.	.	.
race_dum5	.0871097	.	.	.	.
race_dum6	.1272844	.	.	.	.
race_dum7	.0345883	.	.	.	.
race_dum8	.2025529	.	.	.	.
race_dum9	.069388	.	.	.	.
race_dum10	-.0230081	.	.	.	.
race_dum11	.2779757	.	.	.	.
race_dum12	.0445559	.	.	.	.
race_dum13	.021578	.	.	.	.
race_dum14	.0693764	.	.	.	.
race_dum15	.007285	.	.	.	.
race_dum16	.2364164	.	.	.	.
race_dum17	.1384086	.	.	.	.
race_dum18	.0518041	.	.	.	.
race_dum19	-.1576138	.	.	.	.
race_dum20	.1455535	.	.	.	.
race_dum21	.1528581	.	.	.	.
race_dum22	-.4583033	.	.	.	.
race_dum23	-.0395503	.	.	.	.
race_dum24	-.2036076	.	.	.	.
race_dum25	.2250929	.	.	.	.
race_dum26	.2598274	.	.	.	.
educ_dum1	0 (omitted)				
educ_dum2	-.1742387	.0480988	-3.62	0.000	-.2685111 -.0799664
educ_dum3	-.1342917	.0425566	-3.16	0.002	-.2177015 -.0508819
educ_dum4	-.1171189	.0438027	-2.67	0.008	-.2029709 -.0312669
educ_dum5	-.1147171	.0429939	-2.67	0.008	-.1989839 -.0304504
educ_dum6	-.0533639	.043414	-1.23	0.219	-.1384541 .0317263
educ_dum7	-.0493933	.0426975	-1.16	0.247	-.1330691 .0343026
educ_dum8	.0460062	.0430738	1.07	0.285	-.0364171 .1304206
educ_dum9	.218032	.0399591	5.46	0.000	.1397132 .2963507
educ_dum10	.3426158	.0400269	8.56	0.000	.2641642 .4210674
educ_dum11	.4254052	.0403632	10.54	0.000	.3462945 .5045159
educ_dum12	.4636203	.040184	11.54	0.000	.3848608 .5423798
educ_dum13	.7382602	.0399769	18.47	0.000	.6599066 .8166138
educ_dum14	.9691932	.0400879	24.18	0.000	.8906219 1.047764
educ_dum15	1.339485	.0420333	31.87	0.000	1.257101 1.421869
educ_dum16	1.273715	.0410701	31.01	0.000	1.193219 1.354211
classwkr_dum1	-1.459948	.0376389	-38.79	0.000	-1.533719 -1.386177
classwkr_dum2	-2.078084	.0561635	-37.00	0.000	-2.180162 -1.968005
classwkr_dum3	-1.129512	.0481025	-23.48	0.000	-1.223791 -1.035232
classwkr_dum4	-1.215682	.0468987	-25.92	0.000	-1.307602 -1.123762
classwkr_dum5	-1.006952	.0474668	-21.21	0.000	-1.099986 -.9139184
classwkr_dum6	0 (omitted)				
classwkr_dum7	-1.338027	.0470975	-28.41	0.000	-1.430336 -1.245717
classwkr_dum8	-1.365731	.0470886	-29.00	0.000	-1.458024 -1.273439
classwkr_dum9	-1.389094	.1039592	-8.47	0.000	-1.710432 -1.067757
region_dum1	0 (omitted)				
region_dum2	-.0099873	.0071744	-1.39	0.164	-.024049 .0040745
region_dum3	-.0714366	.0067932	-10.52	0.000	-.084751 -.0581222
region_dum4	-.0922637	.0069627	-13.25	0.000	-.1059105 -.0786169
region_dum5	-.0713872	.006245	-11.43	0.000	-.0836272 -.0591473
region_dum6	-.151202	.0077445	-19.52	0.000	-.166381 -.1360229
region_dum7	-.1036256	.0067978	-15.24	0.000	-.1169492 -.090302
region_dum8	-.0984547	.006779	-14.52	0.000	-.1117414 -.085168
region_dum9	.0261805	.0065513	4.00	0.000	.0133401 .0390209
wkstat_dum1	1.414982	.0376416	37.59	0.000	1.341206 1.488759
wkstat_dum2	1.318777	.0380343	34.67	0.000	1.244231 1.393323
wkstat_dum3	1.355974	.0386657	35.07	0.000	1.280191 1.431758
wkstat_dum4	.8761514	.0576066	15.21	0.000	.7632441 .9890586
wkstat_dum5	1.029279	.0440721	23.35	0.000	.9428989 1.115659
wkstat_dum6	1.053913	.0415156	25.39	0.000	.9725434 1.135282
wkstat_dum7	.4998128	.0393263	12.71	0.000	.4227344 .5768911
wkstat_dum8	.5060229	.0379485	13.34	0.000	.4316006 .5803851
wkstat_dum9	.4532257	.0438333	10.34	0.000	.3673136 .5391378
wkstat_dum10	.6221158	.0402979	15.44	0.000	.543133 .7010986
wkstat_dum11	0 (omitted)				
wkstat_dum12	.2798723	.0404324	5.78	0.000	.1849462 .3747985
_cons	9.585886	.	.	.	.